Electrician Knife



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Electrician knife

What it is used for

To cut or strip suitable electrical cable insulation using an electrician knife. To prepare cable ends carefully while avoiding damage to conductors and preventing cuts or electrical injury.

Main parts

- Insulated or shaped handle
- Sharp blade
- Blade guard or sheath
- Grip surface

Before you start

1. Confirm the cable is isolated, de-energized, and verified safe before cutting.
2. Inspect the blade and handle for damage or looseness.
3. Select a knife suitable for the cable and task.
4. Wear appropriate eye protection and follow electrical work procedures.

How to use

1. Secure the cable on a stable work surface.
2. Hold the knife firmly with the blade directed away from the body.
3. Make a shallow controlled cut through the insulation without cutting deeply into the conductor.
4. Rotate or reposition the cable as needed instead of forcing the blade.
5. Remove the insulation carefully and inspect the conductor for nicks or damage.
6. Fit the blade guard or sheath immediately after use.

⚠ Safety

- Never cut or strip an energized cable.
- Keep fingers and the free hand out of the blade path.
- Do not use a blunt, cracked, or loose-blade knife.
- Use an insulated tool only as specified; it does not replace isolation and verification.

Care & storage

- Wipe the blade clean and dry after use.
- Inspect the blade and handle regularly.
- Replace or secure damaged parts before further use.

- Store the knife with its blade covered.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Working on a live cable.
- Cutting too deeply and nicking the conductor.
- Cutting toward the body or supporting hand.
- Leaving the blade exposed during storage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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